1925 ▸ 1930

Frozen food packed in waxed cartons for storage

1925

Fast-frozen foods

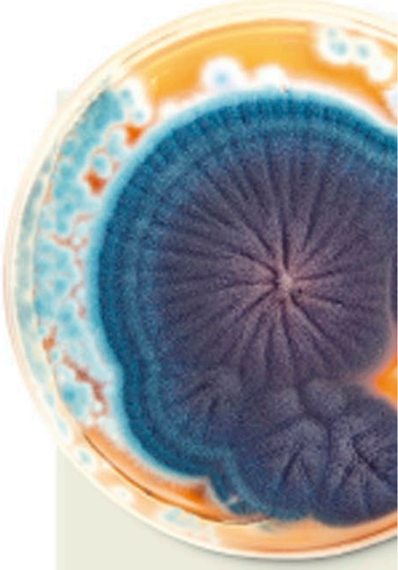
After observing how Inuit peoples in the Arctic froze food rapidly at very low temperatures to preserve its taste and texture, American naturalist Clarence Birdseye invented a double-belt freezer to do the same. His invention kick-started the frozen food industry.

1926

First liquid-fueled rocket

American engineer Robert Goddard launched the first rocket powered by burning liquid fuel, or gasoline. Although the rocket flew only a short distance over 2.5 seconds, it paved the way for Goddard's L-13 rocket in 1937, which reached an altitude of 8,860 ft (2,700 m).

Stamp shows Goddard near the launch frame of his first rocket, nicknamed Nell



Penicillium fungi

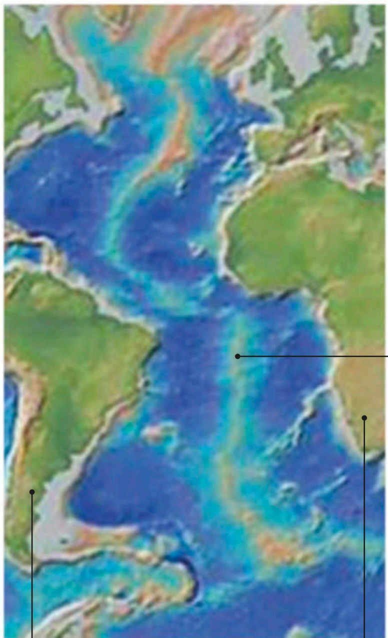
Fleming observed that blue-green *Penicillium* mold on the petri dishes had created a bacteria-free ring around itself. He grew further colonies of this mold and found that it also worked on bacteria that caused diphtheria, pneumonia, and scarlet fever.

1925

1925

Mapping the Mid-Atlantic Ridge

A German scientific expedition discovered that the Mid-Atlantic Ridge runs almost the entire length of the Atlantic Ocean, north-to-south. The ridge extends 1.2–1.9 miles (2–3 km) above the ocean floor and marks the boundary of two tectonic plates. The survey took more than 67,000 depth measurements of the Atlantic over a period of two years.



Map showing the floor of the Atlantic Ocean

Nurse places a polio patient in an iron lung, 1938

1927

Iron lung

American researchers Philip Drinker and Louis Agassiz Shaw invented a boxlike machine called the iron lung—an artificial respirator powered by an electric motor. A patient who could not breathe unaided was placed inside the machine and then air was pumped in and out of it. This changed the air pressure inside it and pulled air into and out of the patient's lungs.

Galaxy classification

In 1926, American astronomer Edwin Hubble grouped galaxies by their shape as they appeared in photographs. Known as the Hubble sequence diagram, it classified galaxies as elliptical, spiral, and barred spiral.